

PELICAN BAY POLICE DEPARTMENT
HOMICIDE DIVISION — EIGHTH DISTRICT
715 South Broad Avenue, New Orleans, LA 70119
(504) 658-6080

VICTIM BACKGROUND REPORT

Case No.: PBPD-2026-034532 | Document No.: 13

Reporting Detective: Det. Renee Broussard, Badge #1887

Date of Report: October 7, 2025

Subject: MARCUS DEMETRIUS WEBB

DOB / Age / Sex / Race: 03/14/1991 / 34 / Male / Black

Address: 4421 Briarcliff Rd, Atlanta, GA 30329

Spouse: Janelle Webb, 32 (Atlanta, GA) — m. 2017

Children: One child, age 5

Employment: Self-employed — freelance investigative journalist; regular contributor to Atlanta Sentinel

Education: BA Journalism, Morehouse College (2013); MS Investigative Journalism, Columbia University (2016)

I. SOURCES

Information compiled from: Atlanta PD records check (no priors); GA driver's license and registration; Janelle Webb interview (telephonic, 10/04/2025, 11:30 AM, with Atlanta PD Det. K. Mathis present); Sarah Klein interview (telephonic, 10/04/2025, 2:14 PM); LinkedIn and published-work review; Le Petit Maison hotel records; Webb's personal laptop (under separate warrant SW-2025-1143, returned to spouse 10/06).

II. RECENT TRAVEL

Hotel: Le Petit Maison, 1124 Royal Street, New Orleans. Check-in October 1, 2025 at 3:12 PM. Reservation through October 5, 2025 — return flight to Atlanta scheduled ATL via DL2241 on 10/05 at 6:45 AM. Hotel staff reported no incidents; Webb was "quiet, polite, gone most evenings."

Prior NOLA trips this year (per credit card and frequent-flyer records): July 16-18, 2025; August 28-31, 2025. All recorded under personal expense; Atlanta Sentinel records indicate stories were not yet under contract but Klein was aware of the work.

III. PROFESSIONAL CONTEXT — WORK IN PROGRESS

Per editor Sarah Klein, Webb was working on a long-form investigative piece, working title **"Tourist Trap: A Pattern of Unsolved Violence in the French Quarter."** The piece focused on a string of approximately 11 tourist-victim assaults in the French Quarter dating to 2023 with low clearance rates, alleged organized involvement, and possible payments to silence victims. Klein stated Webb believed he had identified a loose group of perpetrators centered on regulars at a single Bourbon Street bar and was in the process of corroborating sources. Klein had not yet seen a draft and was unaware of specific names; she stated Webb "was careful — sources, not names, until he had the goods."

Webb's 9:14 PM October 3 voice call to Klein (per Doc 12) was a check-in. Klein recalled Webb saying he was "going to the source tonight to see for himself" and that he would "sit quietly and write notes — not interview." Klein had advised him to be cautious and had no further contact prior to the 2:31 AM SMS "Got it. I'm leaving."

IV. SPOUSE INTERVIEW SUMMARY

Janelle Webb described her husband as cautious, dedicated, and emotionally measured. She confirmed the New Orleans trip was for the story. She was unaware of any specific threats but stated her husband had been "more careful than usual" since August — checking his phone, double-locking doors, asking her not to discuss his itinerary with friends. She knew the piece concerned violence but did not know names. She has no knowledge of anyone named Cody, Brett, or Ryan. She confirmed Webb did not own a firearm, did not use illegal drugs, drank occasionally, and had no financial distress (recent book advance of \$45,000 from W.W. Norton; mortgage current). No domestic

concerns; relationship described as stable. Marriage counseling referenced in 2022 was for general communication; resolved. Next-of-kin notification was completed in person by Atlanta PD at 11:18 AM on 10/04.

V. CRIMINAL HISTORY

None. NCIC, GCIC, Louisiana SCH all return no criminal history. One traffic citation (speeding, 2019, GA, paid). No protective orders. No civil litigation aside from a routine landlord-tenant matter in 2014 (resolved).

VI. FINANCIAL OVERVIEW

Joint household income approximately \$148,000 (spouse Janelle is a public-school principal in DeKalb County). Webb's freelance income variable; Atlanta Sentinel retainer of \$1,500/month plus per-piece. Book advance noted above. Two credit cards, both under limits and current. No unusual transactions in the 60 days preceding death. No life insurance fraud indicators. Will and life insurance through spouse's employer; spouse named beneficiary.

VII. ASSESSMENT

Marcus Webb's professional work in active investigation of organized violence centered on The Rusty Anchor, his documented surveillance and recordings on the night of his death, and his recorded statement on the final voice memo ("They've seen me") together establish a direct nexus between his journalism and the events leading to his death. No alternative motives (robbery, domestic, personal dispute) are supported by available evidence.

Reporting Detective: _____ Det. R. Broussard #1887

Supervisor Review: Lt. Andre Fontenot, Homicide Unit — 10/07/2025